THE COMPLETE FIELD GUIDE

Rocket League: A Practical Handbook

How Rocket League works—from first kickoff to high-level play.



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Updated 14 October 2026
A visual, source-linked guide for new players and experienced competitors

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Updated 14 October 2026

> **Scope note.** This manuscript synthesizes only the supplied verified research. “Current” means supported at the stated cutoff; seasonal playlists, item catalogs, schedules, and platform behavior can change. Historical, removed, rotating, community-tested, and uncertain material is labeled rather than presented as a permanent rule.

1. From SARPBC to Season 24

Rocket League is the modern successor to **Supersonic Acrobatic Rocket-Powered Battle-Cars (SARPBC)**. Psyonix says SARPBC first came to PlayStation 3 in October 2008; Rocket League launched on 7 July 2015. [1] The premise remained simple and unusually durable: rocket-powered cars play football-like matches with one ball, but the resulting game is a physics-driven sport rather than a conventional racing or football game.

Psyonix announced that it was joining the Epic Games family on 1 May 2019. The announcement described an expected closing window in late May or early June, planned an Epic Games Store release, and confirmed that Steam owners would retain access. The announcement date is not the same thing as a documented closing date. [2]

Full cross-platform matchmaking went live on 14 January 2019 for PlayStation 4, Nintendo Switch, Xbox One, and Steam, across Casual, Competitive, and Extra Modes. [3] Rocket League then became free to play on 23 September 2020 at 8 a.m. PDT / 3 p.m. UTC, alongside its Epic Games Store launch. The transition added Epic account linking, Legacy Status, tournaments, and challenges, and removed the Solo Standard playlist. [4]

What “free to play” changed

Free-to-play progression uses an Epic Games Account and a selected **Primary Platform**. Rank, Rocket Pass progress, XP, and most inventory can be shared across linked platforms, but Credits and Esports Tokens remain platform-specific; platform-exclusive items and several licensed or ultimate-DLC categories have exceptions. Current support documentation should take precedence over launch-era wording when the two differ. [5], [6]

The currently listed supported platforms are PC, PlayStation 4/5, Xbox One/One S/Series X|S, and Nintendo Switch. The official play page links Epic PC, PlayStation, Xbox, and Nintendo storefronts. [7], [8] macOS and old Linux/SteamOS online support was removed: Psyonix’s January 2020 announcement said the final patch in March would disable online functionality while leaving local and split-screen play. Current Epic support says Steam Deck/Linux can be played but macOS cannot. [9], [10]

The 2026 state

At the requested cutoff, the latest dated official patch located was **v2.77**, released 6 October 2026 at 4 p.m. PT / 11 p.m. UTC. It reduced Honor Duels from five to three minutes and allows forfeits after 60 seconds; it also fixed several UI, item, and cosmetic issues. [11] **Season 24** began 23 September 2026. Its notable features are summarized below; menu labels and event availability may change. [12], [19]

Feature	What it does, how it works, and how to use it	What makes it special / cutoff status
Honor Duel	During a match, challenge another player to a 1v1 in the same match type. If accepted, the duel starts after the current match; other players can spectate.	A social post-match rematch that turns a disagreement into a short, opt-in duel. The current duel lasts 3 minutes; forfeits open after 60 seconds. [11], [12], [19]
Black Market Trade-In	Trade in three duplicate Black Market items through Trade In to receive a wholly new Black Market item or a painted version you do not yet collect. Review eligible items before confirming.	A new sink/use for duplicate top-rarity cosmetics; it is not player-to-player trading. [12], [19]
Custom scoreboard	Choose four unique trackable stats for each mode to display beside the score; options include Demos, High Fives, and Flip Resets as well as familiar stats.	Lets players foreground personal goals or a mode-specific skill instead of seeing only the standard stat trio. [12], [19]
MVP podium	At the end of a match, the MVP's equipped Goal Explosion plays in the open net behind the team, with its name displayed.	Makes an existing cosmetic part of a team celebration; equip the desired explosion in the Garage. [12], [19]
Free Look and modernized KBM controls	A Free Look Camera lets players direct the camera away from its usual follow target; an optional center-dot reticle supports it. New mouse-and-keyboard defaults/ settings arrived, and Free Look can also be enabled for controller players.	A notable camera/input update rather than a change to ball physics; try the new controls in Free Play before using them in a ranked match. [19]
Top-100 ranked titles	Finish in a placement band on the global 1v1, 2v2, or 3v3 Soccar leaderboard; qualifying titles are granted at season end.	A season-specific cosmetic/status reward for the highest leaderboard places, not a separate matchmaking tier. [12], [19]
Run it Up / event rotations	Run it Up adds 14 challenges and Nova Collection drops, including cosmetics and titles that track Season 24 wins/MVPs. Bullet Ball and Persona 5 also ran as limited-time events.	On 14 October, Run it Up was announced through 9 December; Bullet Ball ended 6 October and Persona 5 ended 12 October. Do not describe expired LTEs as currently selectable. Bullet Ball's last-car-standing rules use a homing ball, dodge-parry, timed backflip freeze, and grab. [12], [19]
Season 24 Rocket Pass bodies	The pass features Volkswagen Golf GTI Edition 50 (Octane hitbox), Dominus GT 76 (Dominus), and Pareto 5S (Breakout), alongside other cosmetics.	A useful example of licensed/current body names mapping to standardized collision families; no Rocket Pass price or full reward list is asserted here. [12]

Engine roadmap: announced future work, not a live build

The official Rocket League homepage is promoting a "New Era. New Engine." teaser. Insider Gaming reports that the current game is built on Unreal Engine 3, that the transition is to Unreal Engine 6, and that the next era is targeted for 2027, with professional players involved in testing. Treat the year and testing detail as reported roadmap information: the UE6 game is not the live client at this cutoff, and no new system requirements or performance targets have been published. [58], [73]

Label	Meaning in this book
Current	Supported by documentation at 14 October 2026, but still subject to later patches.
Seasonal/rotating	Availability can change with the season, week, or live event. Check the client.
Historical/removed	Once documented, but no longer a safe assumption for current play.
Community-tested	Useful technical or coaching evidence outside Psyonix/Epic's official rules.

A first-hour plan

A beginner does not need advanced mechanics to understand Rocket League. Start in Tutorials/Training, learn throttle, steering, braking, jump, double-jump, Ball Cam, basic shots and saves, then play a casual match. In the first session, prioritize three habits:

1. **Read before committing:** ask whether you can reach the ball before jumping or boosting.
2. **Recover:** land on your wheels and turn back toward useful space.
3. **Communicate:** on kickoffs, use "I've Got It!" or "Defending!" rather than silently sending everyone at the ball. [13]

An experienced player uses the same loop—spawn, read, challenge/pass/clear, recover and rotate—but adds boost routes, first-touch control, wall and backboard reads, and deliberate third-man coverage.

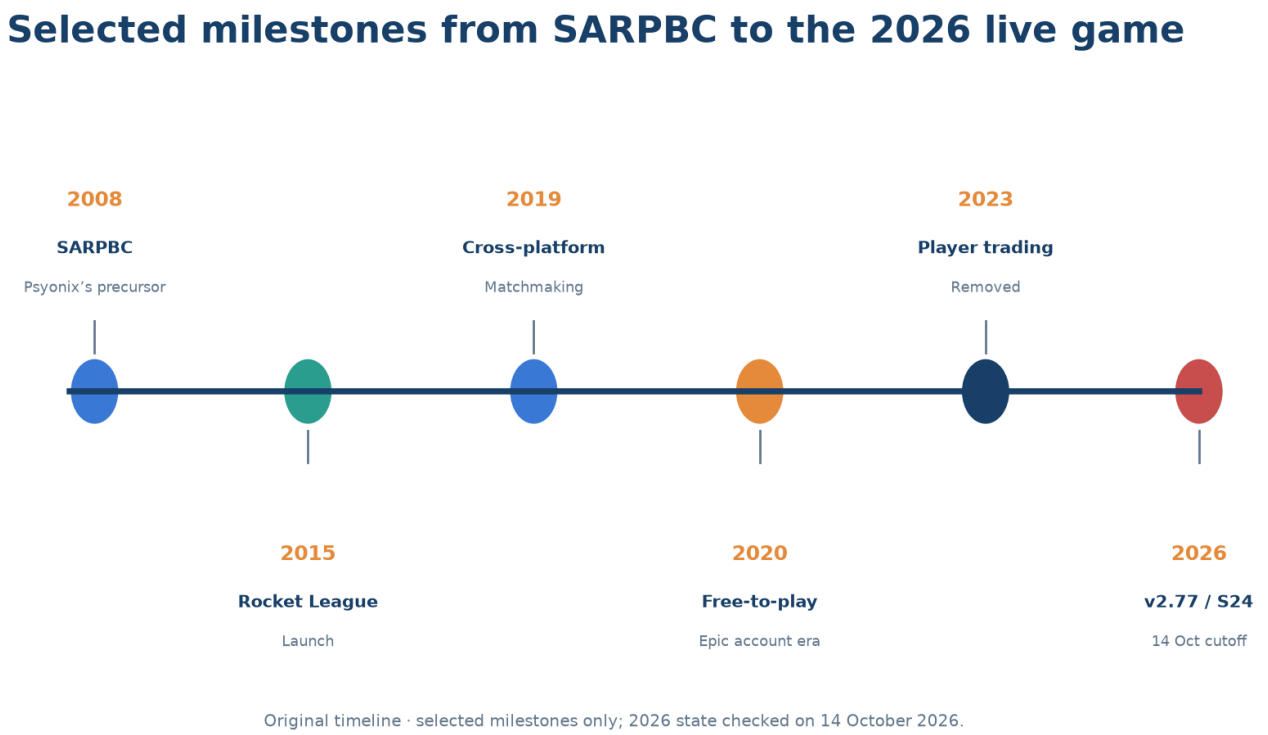


Figure 01. Original diagram. Selected milestones, not a complete patch history; dates follow official announcements. [1], [3], [4], [5], [11], [12]

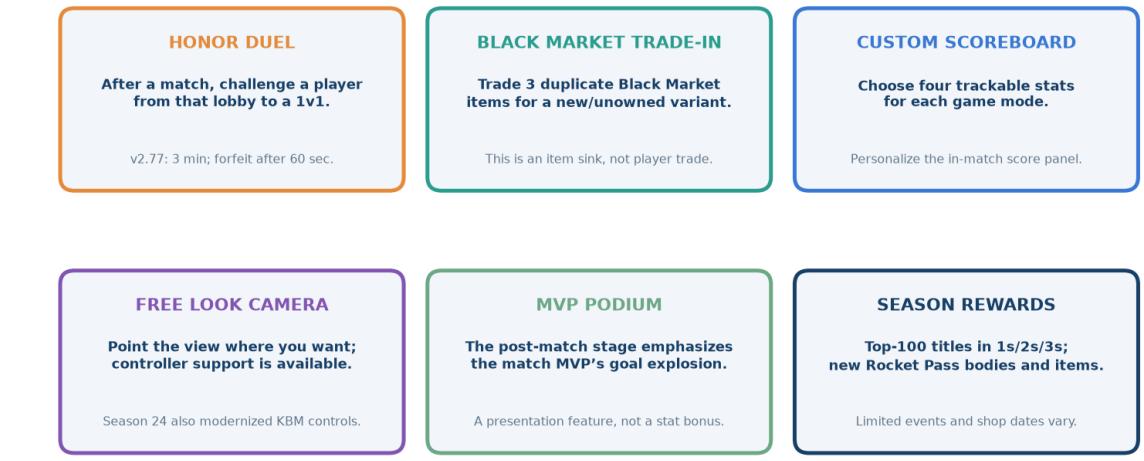


Figure 02. Original diagram. Feature summary current through 14 October 2026; event status is date-labeled. [11], [12], [19]

2. The Match: Ball, Goals, Arenas, and Team Play

The core loop

Two teams use rocket-powered cars to contest one ball, create a shot or save, and score into the opponent’s goal. After a goal, the game resets for another kickoff. In the cited competitive rules, a game ends when the in-game Winner screen appears after 0:00 or when overtime is resolved by the first goal. [14], [15]

In a normal five-minute competitive game, a 2–1 lead at 0:00 wins immediately. A 2–2 tie does not become a draw under the cited competitive definition: play continues into overtime, and the first goal resolves the game. Tournament formats can wrap games into a best-of-X match, so winning a game is not necessarily winning the whole event. [15], [16]



Figure 03. A close-range goal threat illustrates why defenders must cover the goal mouth and read the next touch. Historical Rocket League press-kit image; source gallery; rights remain with the relevant rights holder.

Standard competitive baseline

RLCS 2026 rules specify DFH Stadium as the default arena, 3v3 team size, no bots, no mutators, and a five-minute match clock. This is the clearest official baseline for standard Soccar-style competition—not a claim that every casual, private, or special match has those settings. [14]

Situation	Beginner interpretation	Experienced interpretation
Ball coming toward you	Can I clear it safely?	Can I control the first touch or turn it into a pass?
Teammate challenges	Cover behind rather than follow	Preserve spacing and become the third man if needed
Ball in the corner	Avoid a blind center hit	Read the rebound, opponent pressure, and backboard option
You have no boost	Use small pads and position goal-side	Maintain pressure through efficient routes and low-boost challenges
Clock reaches 0:00	The score decides unless tied under competitive overtime	Know the event’s game/match format and overtime rule



Figure 04. A mid-field challenge with multiple cars closing on the ball; use the space behind the first challenger for cover. Historical Rocket League press-kit image; source gallery; rights remain with the relevant rights holder.

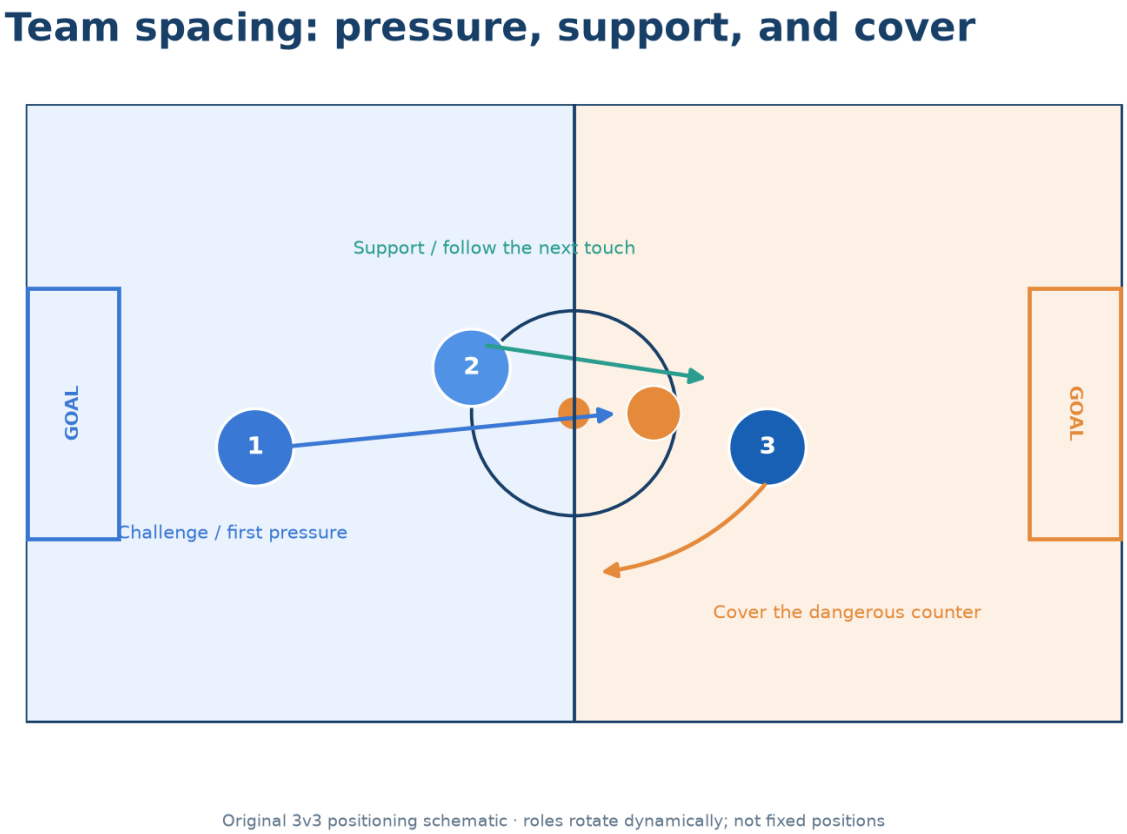


Figure 05. Original diagram. Team spacing and third-man cover; roles shift with the play and are not fixed positions. [13]

Kickoffs

A kickoff is a controlled restart, not ordinary open play. A player from each team normally challenges the ball while teammates cover likely outcomes. Psyonix's beginner guidance identifies diagonal spawns as the best kickoff challenge position and recommends "I've Got It!" or "Defending!" [13]

A simple kickoff plan is:

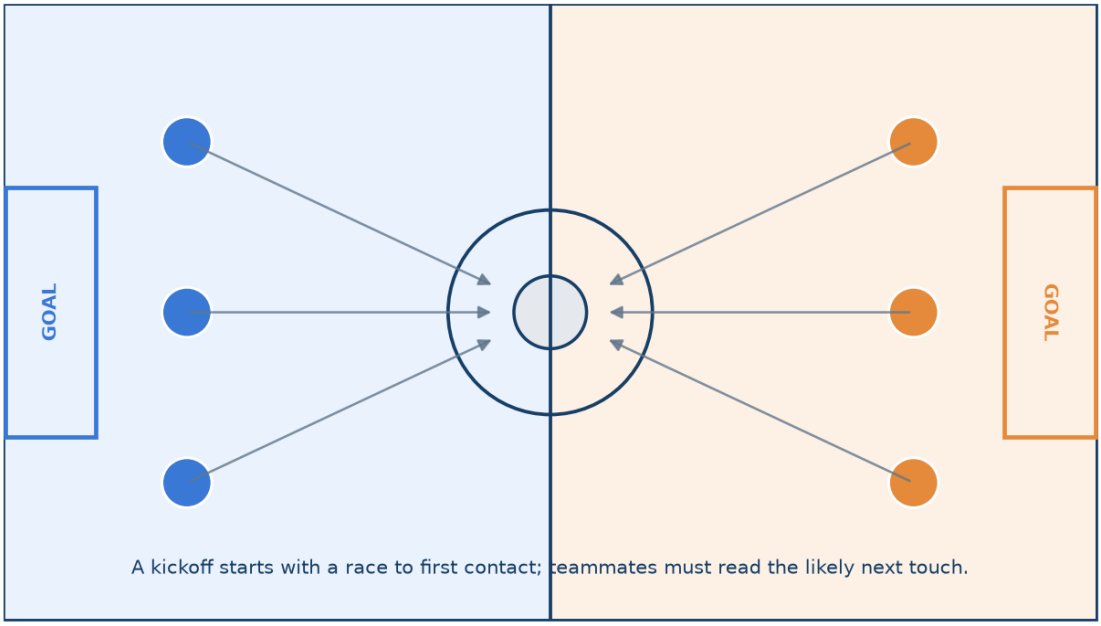
- **Challenger:** take the ball from the assigned spawn.
- **Cheater:** move behind the challenger at a useful distance, ready for a dead ball or win.
- **Defender:** protect the goal and read the kickoff result.

Do not send every teammate. At higher levels, a team may choose a delayed kickoff, directional kickoff, fake, or other community-tested variant based on spawn, callouts, and opponent tendencies. Those variants are strategies, not universal rules.



Figure 06. Kickoff view: the GO cue, central ball, clock, and boost display make the restart context visible. Historical Rocket League press-kit image; source gallery; rights remain with the relevant rights holder.

Kickoff: first contact is only the start of the play



Original kickoff schematic · positions vary by formation; not to scale

Figure 07. Original diagram. Kickoff roles and possible outcomes; a tactical example, not a compulsory formation. [13]

Arena geometry

The normal field is rectangular and enclosed by floor, side walls, back walls, ceiling, corners, boost pads, and recessed goals. The ball rebounds from floor, walls, and backboard and scores when it enters a goal. RLBot's community technical reference reports standard-coordinate values of side walls x=±4096, back walls y=±5120, ceiling z=2048, goal height z=642.775, goal center-to-post 892.755, goal depth 880, and ball radius 91.25 Unreal units. It notes that one Unreal unit is approximately one centimetre and warns that boost locations can vary by map. These are technical community values, not an official player-facing measurement sheet. [17]

For a beginner, the practical consequences are more important than the numbers:

- Side walls keep a ball alive and can turn a clearance into a dangerous return.
- Corners slow and redirect the ball; a corner is not automatically a safe possession.
- Backboards are defensive surfaces and attacking launch points.
- A clear toward the corner or a teammate is generally safer than a blind hit across the middle.

An experienced player plans rebounds from the wall and backboard, recognizes whether the next contact is reachable, and uses the ceiling height and goal geometry to decide whether to challenge or retreat.

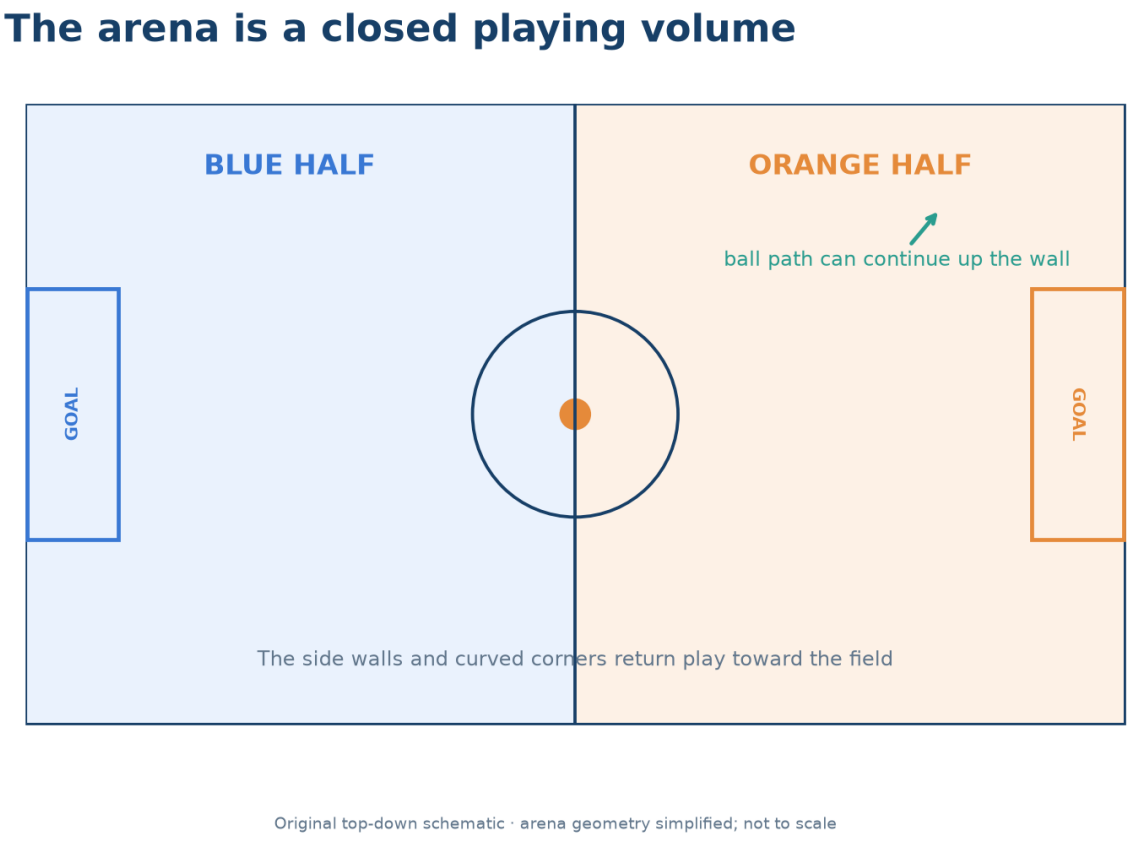


Figure 08. Original diagram. Approximate standard-field geometry in community technical coordinates; map/mode variations may differ. [17]

Camera awareness

Ball Cam centers the view around the ball and is a field-awareness tool. **Player Cam** is useful for precise car control, lining up a pickup, or checking nearby space. Camera settings include FOV, Height, Angle, Distance, Stiffness, Swivel Speed, Camera Shake, and a Ball Cam Indicator. [13], [18]

Raise FOV if a wider view helps, turn Camera Shake off for a steadier image, and change one setting at a time in Free Play. There is no single official best numeric preset. Season 24’s v2.76 update added Free Look Camera, updated mouse-and-keyboard defaults, and an optional center-dot reticule; Free Look is also available to controller players. [19]

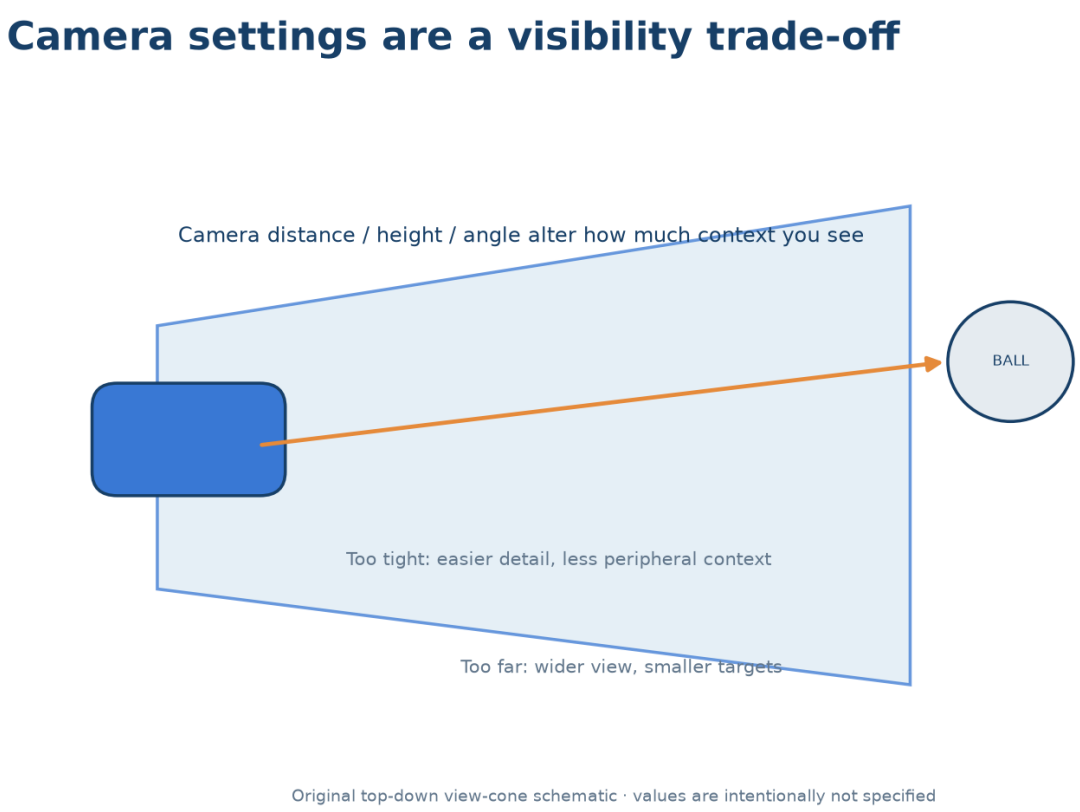


Figure 09. Original diagram. Camera choices trade wide awareness against precision; there is no single official numeric preset. [18], [19]

3. Cars, Hitboxes, and Physics

Six families, not hundreds of unique competitive bodies

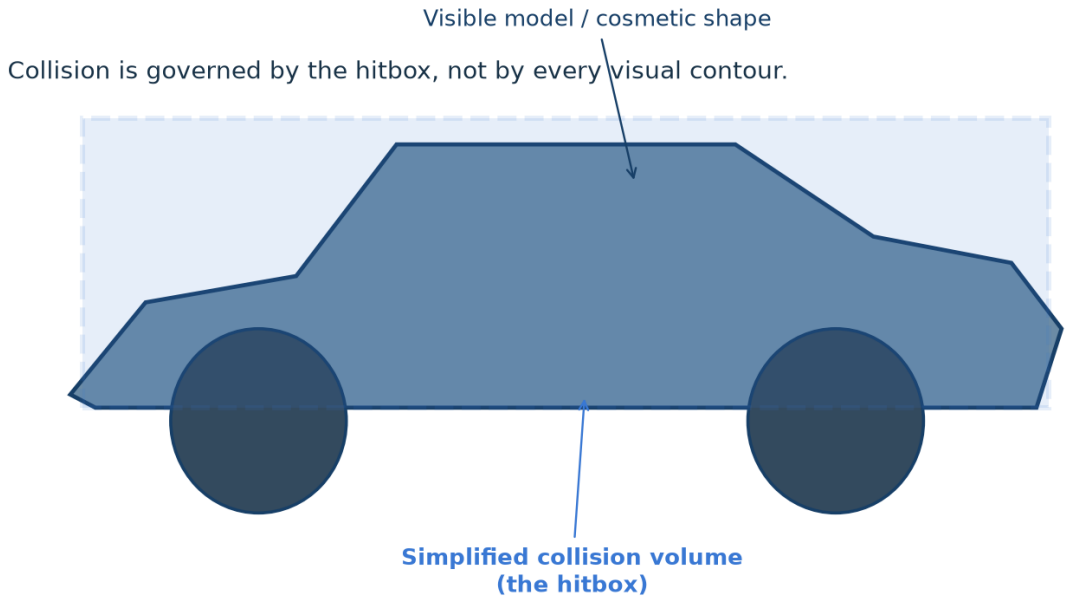
Every car body is assigned to one of six default hitbox families: **Breakout, Dominus, Hybrid, Merc, Octane, and Plank**. Epic says all cars have the same overall stats, while families differ slightly in length, width, and height. A rendered body and its collision box are therefore separate concepts. [20]

Examples of official mappings include Fennec = Octane, Dominus GT = Dominus, Jäger 619 = Hybrid, and Mantis = Plank. Mappings are version-sensitive; use the current official list rather than visual resemblance. Official notes identify Corlay as Octane, Magnifique and Magnifique GXT as Dominus, Dodge Charger Daytona Scat Pack as Dominus, and Azura as Breakout. [21], [22]

Family	Approximate community dimensions (length × width × height, uu)	Practical note
Breakout	131.49 × 80.52 × 30.30	Long profile; useful reach is a geometric characteristic, not a guaranteed advantage.
Plank	128.82 × 84.67 × 29.39	Long and broad, with a low approximate height.
Dominus	127.93 × 83.28 × 31.30	Commonly used body family; no family is officially “best.”
Hybrid	127.02 × 82.19 × 34.16	Intermediate shape.
Merc	120.72 × 76.71 × 41.66	Tall approximate profile.
Octane	118.01 × 84.20 × 36.16	Broad, compact approximate profile.

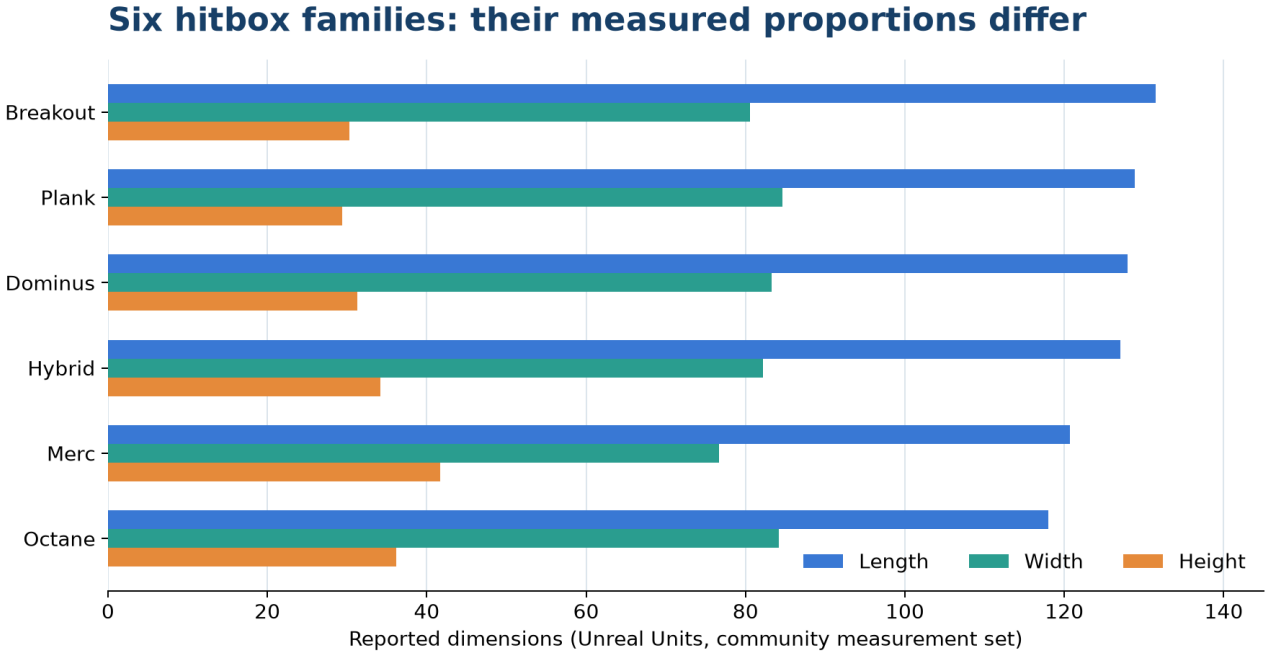
The measurements above are community measurements/compilations in Unreal units, not an official Psyonix dimension table. [23], [24] The safest competitive conclusion is that every family is viable; perceived preference and geometry matter, but “best hitbox” is community interpretation.

What “hitbox” means



Original side-view schematic · generic car, not an exact in-game model

Figure 10. Original diagram. Conceptual, not to scale: rendered bodywork and its assigned collision family are distinct. [20]



Original chart · community-documented values, not an official Psyonix dimension table; methods/version may vary.

Figure 11. Original diagram. Approximate community-measured dimensions in Unreal units; Epic confirms the families but does not publish this complete numeric table. [20], [23], [24]

A practical contact model

Community technical documentation attributes bounce direction to a vector from the car's center/root area toward the collision point rather than simply to the visible bumper surface. This helps explain why a curved-looking nose does not guarantee a curved-surface reflection. Treat it as a tested model, not a published official formula. [24]

RLBot's maintained game-value model reports normal gravity of 650 uu/s², ball radius 91.25 uu, ball mass 30 in arbitrary engine units, coefficient of restitution 0.60, and a ball maximum speed of 6000 uu/s. It also reports car mass 180, boost-assisted maximum speed 2300 uu/s, a supersonic threshold of 2200 uu/s, and maximum angular velocity of 5.5 rad/s. These values explain why incoming velocity, contact point, and orientation affect a touch; they are community reverse-engineering documentation, not official design constants. [26]

A jump is more than a one-frame lift. RLBot documents gravity, a short post-jump sticky force toward nearby surfaces, a first-jump hold bonus, and a second-jump window reported at roughly 1.25–1.45 seconds. A dodge/flip is an impulse after the jump, so timing and orientation change the car's velocity at contact. Again, these figures are technical community findings. [27]



Figure 12. Two cars contest the ball in the air, illustrating how orientation and contact point shape a challenge. Historical Rocket League press-kit image; source gallery; rights remain with the relevant rights holder.

Mutators are not standard physics

Official Season 18 notes distinguish ordinary play from custom mutators: Jumps can allow multiple jumps or disable jumps; Ball Gravity can be low, high, super, or default; Dodge Timer can be changed. Do not generalize a mutator result to ranked Soccar. [22]

4. Modes, Playlists, Tournaments, and Special Events

Rocket League's menu is best understood as several kinds of play rather than one permanent catalog:

1. **Competitive:** ranked matchmaking and seasonal rank progression.
2. **Casual:** unranked matchmaking.
3. **Arcade/Extra Modes:** rotating or seasonally assigned variations.
4. **Tournaments:** scheduled or custom bracketed competition.
5. **Private, LAN, Offline, and Training:** controlled or non-matchmaking environments.

The Play-menu redesign grouped Competitive Playlists and Extra Modes under one Competitive card, allowed up to six competitive playlists at once, and introduced Casual Arcade Playlists, a Large Party playlist, Offline, Private/LAN Match, and Training destinations. Later seasons mean the client's live menu remains authoritative rather than that 2023 preview. [28]

Team sizes and playlists

3v3 Standard is a sensible starting queue and the default RLCS team size. Rocket League also has 1v1 and 2v2 Soccar playlists and other modes, but team size and rules are mode-specific. "3v3 Standard" means three cars per side; it does not mean every match is 3v3.

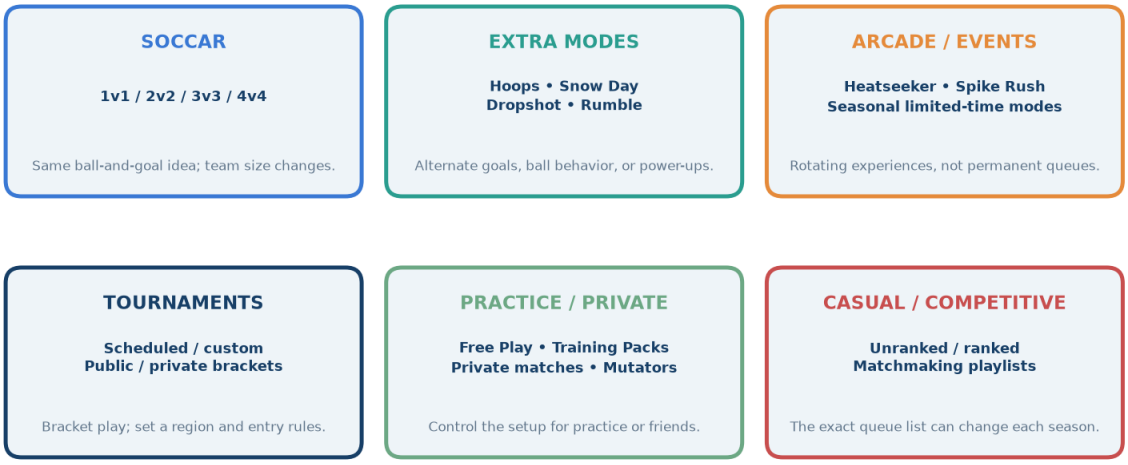
Playlist identity changes. Season 22 kept Snowday ranked, returned Ranked Dropshot, removed ranked Quads, and added 2v2 Ranked Heatseeker. Season 20 moved Snowday from Competitive to Casual, made 4v4 Quads the Large Party mode instead of 4v4 Chaos, and described Quads as Casual-available; Season 21 moved Dropshot into Casual when Snowday replaced it in Ranked. [29], [30]

Feature	Status at cutoff
Standard 1v1, 2v2, 3v3	Core playlist types; exact queue presentation is client-controlled.
Competitive Extra Modes	**Seasonal/rotating**; Snowday, Dropshot, Quads, Heatseeker and others can move slots.
Dueling Arcade Playlists	**Rotating**; the more-played of two modes can remain another week, while the less popular rotates out.
4v4 Chaos	**Historical slot transition**; do not assume it is the current Large Party mode.
Knockout	**Historical/season-dependent**; do not describe permanent availability.
Limited-time events	**Event-bound**; check News, Challenges, and Play.



Figure 13. The stylized arena lighting, reflective surface, and effects are visual presentation; the screenshot does not imply a different ruleset. Historical Rocket League press-kit image; source gallery; rights remain with the relevant rights holder.

Rocket League is a game of playlists and rotating rule sets



Original diagram · mode examples are not a promise of live availability; the in-game Play menu and event panels are authoritative.

Figure 14. Original diagram. Mode families and season-dependent playlist rotation; the live Play menu is authoritative. [28], [29], [30]

Tournaments

Scheduled Tournaments are bracketed competitions, not ordinary playlist games. Custom Tournaments are reached through Play > Tournaments > Custom. Players can browse/filter, create public brackets, or join a private bracket by name and password. Organizers can set region, platform/rank requirements, arena rotation, and spectating. [31]

Private and offline sessions are useful for practice but should not be confused with public ranked progression. Private Matches award only time-based XP—2 XP/sec, capped at 600 XP per match—and no win, daily-win, or multiplier bonuses under the cited notes. [30]

Limited-time events

Special modes are deliberately temporary. Examples in the supplied research include a December 2025 Bring the Heat event around Ranked Heatseeker and the FIFA World Cup 2026 LTE, which included country selection, online matches, a global leaderboard, and rewards. Season 22 added support for multiple concurrent LTEs. Whether a particular LTE is live on 14 October 2026 requires checking the current client; this handbook does not infer it. [29], [30]

5. Controls, Camera, Boost, and Core Movement

Controls before mechanics

Rebind controls to fit your hands. Learn throttle, brake/reverse, steering, jump, boost, powerslide, air roll, Ball Cam, and Player Cam before adding complicated inputs. Epic recommends handbrake/powerslide for quicker turns and recommends learning Ball Cam early. [13], [32]

Powerslide is a tool for sharp turns while retaining more speed. Use short taps through turns, on wall exits, and after bumps; holding it too long produces a slow spin and loses defensive shape.

Boost

On standard Soccar maps, RLBot reports 28 small pads—12 boost each, with a 4-second refresh—and six large pads—100 boost, with a 10-second refresh. Dignitas reports a conflicting 5-second small-pad respawn. Because this is community documentation rather than an official immutable rule and the sources conflict, use the 4-second RLBot figure as a technical reference, not a promise; verify precision in your build or replay. [26], [34]

Boost management is positioning:

- Feather boost to preserve altitude and control.
- Stop boosting when the ball is no longer reachable.
- Use flips and wavedashes to gain speed without spending boost.
- Do not abandon goal-side coverage merely to take a corner boost.
- As third man, value position and small pads over a dramatic detour.

A beginner should learn a route through nearby small pads. An experienced player asks whether a pad pickup preserves pressure, covers the counterattack, and leaves a useful first touch.



Figure 15. A car accelerates toward the ball; a trail is a visual cue, while boost remains a limited resource. Historical Rocket League press-kit image; source gallery; rights remain with the relevant rights holder.

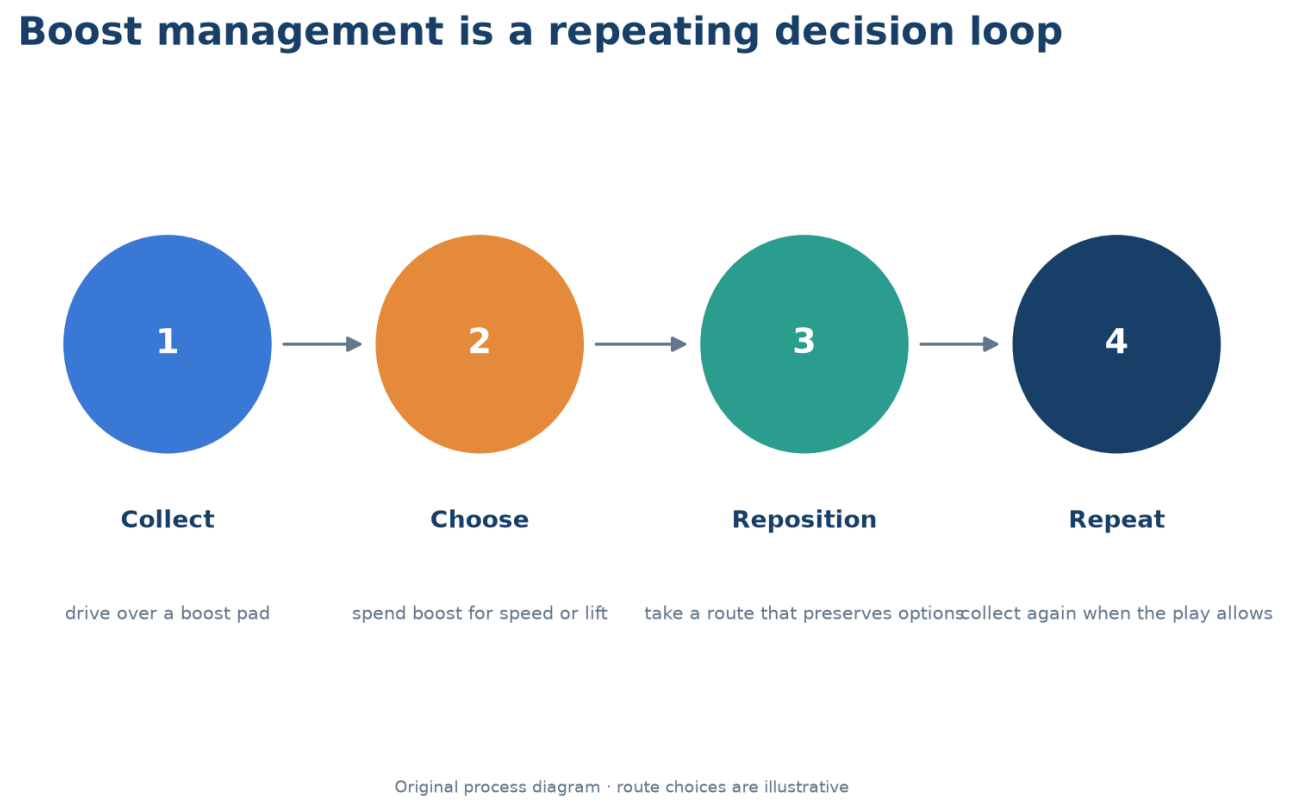


Figure 16. Original diagram. Original boost-management schematic; pad timing/counts are technical references and small-pad timing is disputed. [26], [34]



Figure 17. Original diagram. Standard-map pad value comparison; RLBot and Dignitas differ on the small-pad refresh time. [26], [34]

Jumping and air roll

Hold Jump for a higher first jump; a second jump becomes a dodge/flip and can add speed or shot power. Jump plus Boost is the quickest basic climb. Air Roll controls orientation, not lift; use it to align the car and land wheels-first. Spending the second jump too early removes recovery or flip options.

Core movement progression

Stage	Skill	Test
1	Throttle, brake, powerslide, single jump	Turn and stop without losing shape.
2	Double-jump and basic dodge	Reach a ground ball with a purposeful touch.
3	Recoveries	Land wheels-down on floor or wall and continue.
4	Basic aerial steering	Meet a high ball without panicking or overboosting.
5	Fast aerial	Jump twice quickly while boosting.
6	Wall exit and backboard read	Leave the wall aligned and recover.

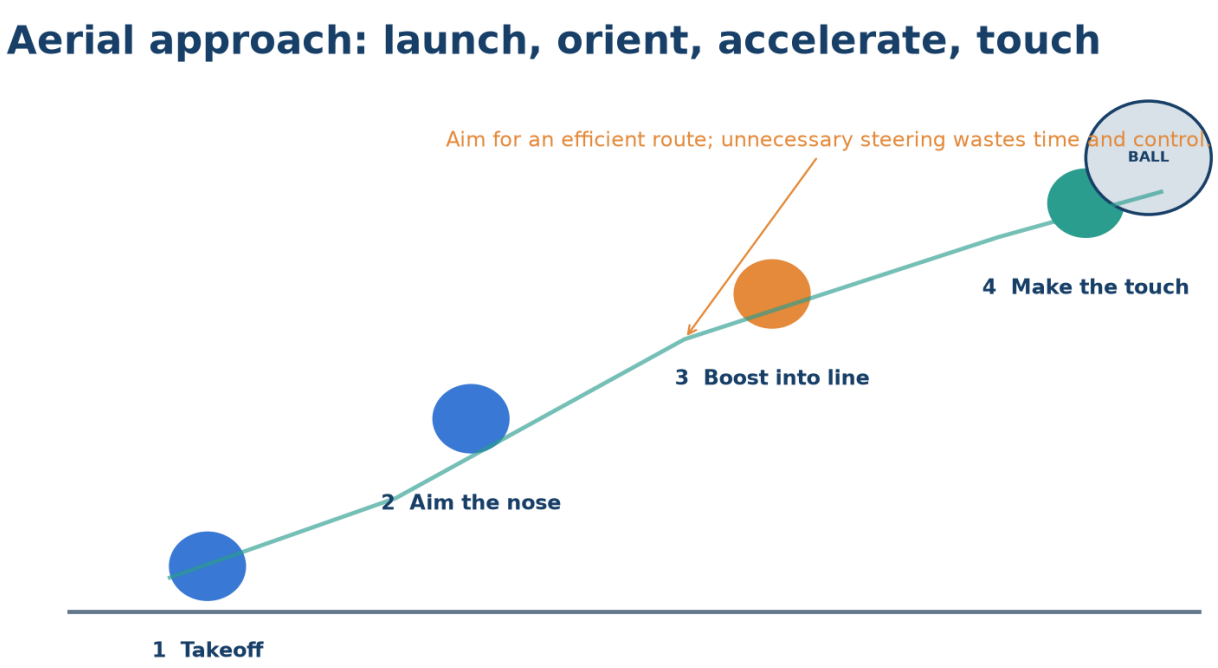


Figure 18. Original diagram. Air Roll changes orientation; jump and boost supply lift/movement. This is a conceptual approach, not fixed timing advice. [32], [35]

The exact camera values and binding layout are personal. Change one variable, test it in Free Play, and retain what improves repeatability rather than what looks impressive in a guide.

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6. Advanced Mechanics and a Safe Learning Order

Advanced mechanics are optional tools, not rank requirements. They are most useful when they improve possession, recovery, or timing rather than merely producing a highlight.

Recoveries: the foundation

A recovery is the ability to land and become useful again. Practice wheels-first landings on the floor and wall, then add powerslide turns, half-flips, and wavedashes.

- **Half-flip:** begin a backward flip, cancel it by pitching the nose forward, and finish facing the original direction. It is a fast turnaround.
- **Wavedash:** time a flip as wheels contact floor, wall, or ramp to preserve or gain speed without the full travel of a normal flip.

These are community-tested definitions and execution details. [35]

Half-flip recovery: reverse the rotation, then land cleanly

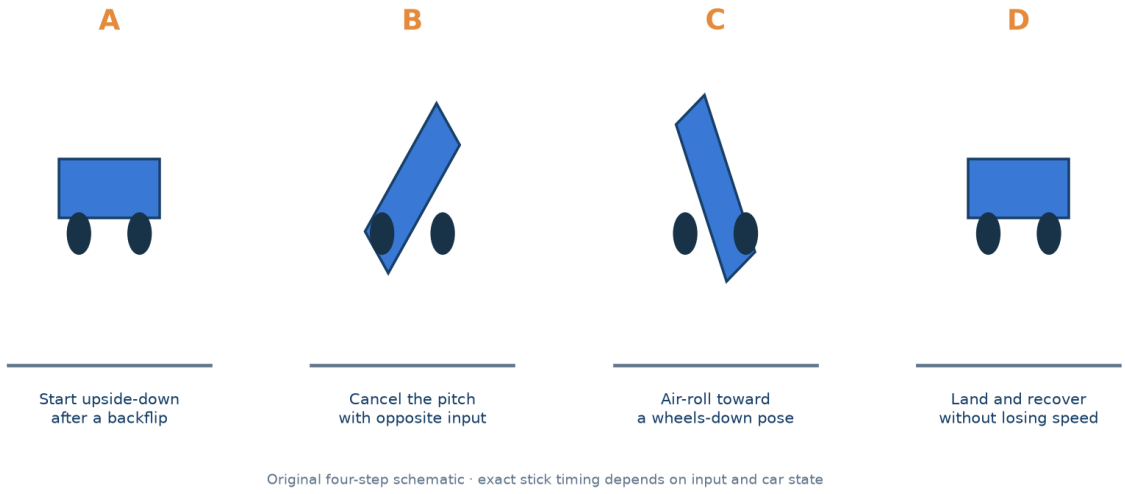


Figure 19. Original diagram. Community-tested half-flip sequence; bindings and exact execution timing vary. [35]

Aerial and wall skills

A **fast aerial** means jumping twice quickly while boosting to gain height sooner. Synchronize the second jump and boost rather than delaying after the first jump. On a wall, drive up with a controlled angle, jump off already aligned, then use air roll to orient the landing. Ceiling movement requires momentum, a planned exit, and a recovery plan.

An **air dribble** begins with a controlled pop, often from a wall. Jump after the ball, match its speed beneath or behind it, and feather boost for soft touches toward goal. The goal is controlled possession, not maximum speed; running out of boost or carrying the ball too far gives the defender an easy challenge.



Figure 20. A contested touch shows why recovery and a useful landing matter after an aerial challenge. Historical Rocket League press-kit image; source gallery; rights remain with the relevant rights holder.



Figure 21. Wall-side play: use the boundary to read the ball's path, then plan a safe landing. Historical Rocket League press-kit image; source gallery; rights remain with the relevant rights holder.



Figure 22. A multi-car aerial contest; the screenshot illustrates visual orientation, not an exact recommended mechanic. Historical Rocket League press-kit image; source gallery; rights remain with the relevant rights holder.

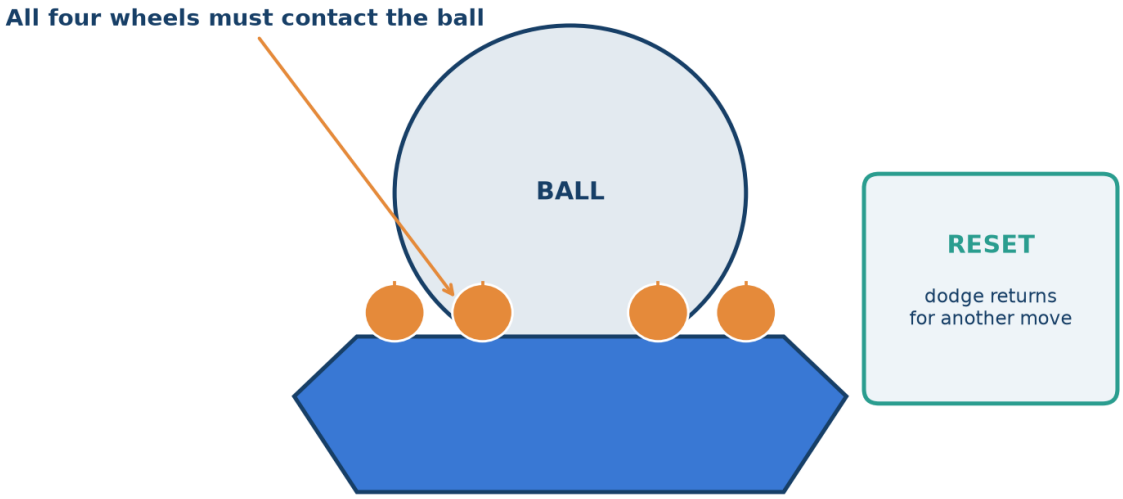
Dribbles and flicks

A ground dribble starts with a stable catch on the hood. An ordinary flick uses a dodge under the ball to launch it. A **musty flick** is a backflip flick with the nose pointed down; delay the backflip until the car is suitably pitched. These require balance, dodge timing, and directional air-roll control. [35]

A **ceiling shot** carries the ball upward, drives onto the ceiling, leaves with a planned shot or dodge, and uses the preserved flip. A **flip reset** occurs when all four wheels contact the ball, restoring the flip; the player can then delay, redirect, or shoot. Both are high-commitment techniques: a miss often concedes a counterattack.

A **speedflip** is a diagonal flip with a rapid flip-cancel and corrective air roll/steering. It can accelerate the car and support fast kickoffs, but a mistimed cancel produces a bad angle. Learn a clean diagonal dodge first, then cancellation, then kickoff timing.

Flip reset: the defining contact is four-wheel contact



Original mechanics schematic · contact angles are simplified; exact setup and execution are community-taught.

Figure 23. Original diagram. Community mechanic illustration: a four-wheel ball contact can restore a dodge; not an official tutorial sequence. [35]

Recommended order

1. Recoveries and wheels-first landings.
2. Powerslide turns, half-flips, and wavedashes.
3. Basic aerials and fast aerials.
4. Wall shots, backboard reads, and controlled air dribbles.
5. Ground dribbles and ordinary flicks.
6. Musty flicks, ceiling shots, and flip resets.
7. Speedflips and kickoff variants.

Prejump’s mechanic taxonomy supports the names and broad definitions; exact input timing is community-tested, not an official competitive standard. [35] Directional Air Roll Left/Right can simplify continuous rotation, but the difficult takeoff direction depends on the bind. Slow-motion practice and small stick corrections are more reliable than frantic inputs. [36]

7. Ranks, Matchmaking, and Competitive Esports

The ladder

The visible ladder runs from Unranked through Bronze, Silver, Gold, Platinum, Diamond, Champion, Grand Champion, and Supersonic Legend. Each named tier has Divisions I–IV. Ranks are playlist-specific, not one universal skill label: Duel, 2v2, 3v3, Rumble, Hoops, Dropshot, Snowday, and other playlists can have separate ranks when available. [37], [38]

At a season start, the first ten games in each Competitive Playlist are placement matches. They establish that playlist's starting rank, which can differ from a friend's even when you party together. Wins generally move divisions/ranks upward and losses downward, but there is no fixed win count for promotion because opponent and party skill affect matchmaking. Exact universal MMR thresholds are not published in the cited official pages. [39], [40]

Since June 2024, placement logic can raise a starting rank in a stale playlist when the player completed at least ten games in another playlist in the prior season, did not play the queued playlist in that season, and is significantly below the rank predicted from other playlists. It does not lower ranks, use Casual performance, or apply to Tournament rank. [41]

Party matchmaking uses a weighted average of party skill rather than simply the highest player. Large rank gaps are matched closer to the highest-ranked member, with Champion-and-higher weighting leaning more toward the highest rank. An undersized party of two queuing 3v3 Standard or a 3v3 Standard Tournament must be within three ranks so the solo third player can be matched to a similarly ranked team; the restriction does not apply to 2v2 or Extra Modes. [40]

Tournament rank is separate from Competitive playlist rank. It starts from the Competitive Playoffs rank and changes each season through tournament wins and losses. A tournament title is therefore not proof of an equivalent 2v2, 3v3, or Rumble rank. [42]

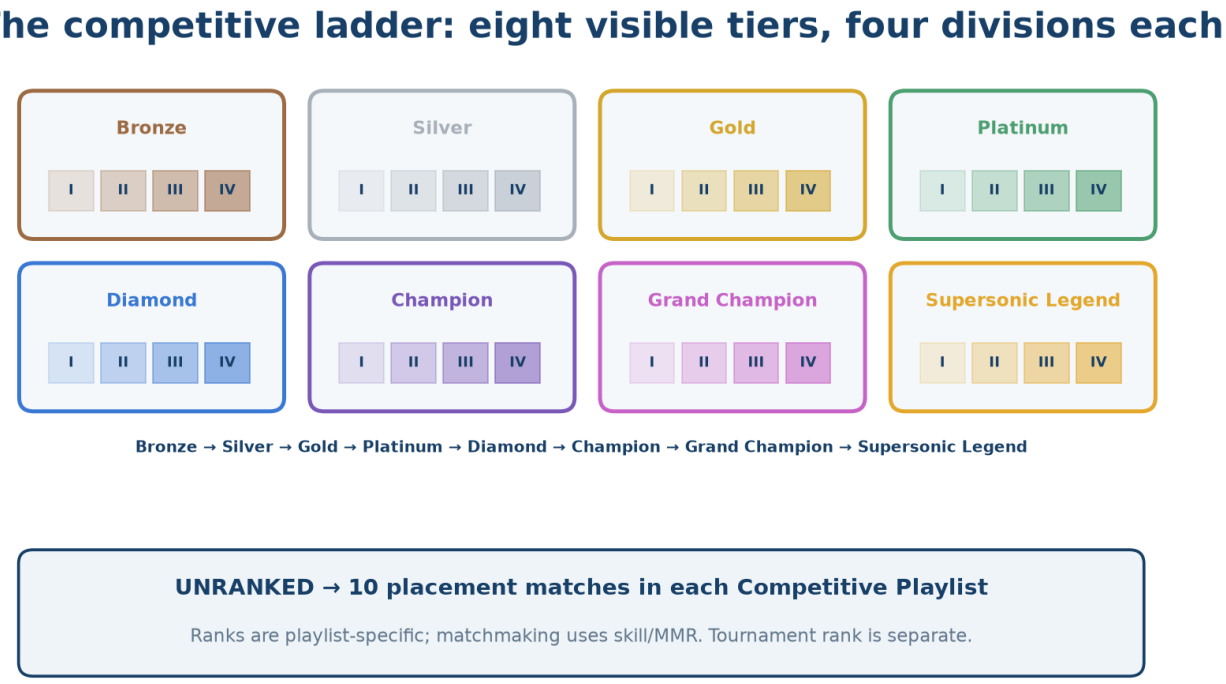


Figure 24. Original diagram. Playlist-specific ladder with Divisions I–IV at each tier; universal numeric MMR thresholds are unpublished. [37], [39]

Improvement without rank obsession

Treat rank as a measurement of a playlist's results, not a complete description of a player. A Gold player may have strong shooting but poor recoveries; a Champion player may have refined aerial mechanics but weak decision-making in a new mode. Track controllable behaviors: first-touch quality, boost waste, challenge timing, and whether a missed touch left a teammate exposed.

RLCS is a different ladder

RLCS 2026 is organized esports, not ranked matchmaking. The official announcement described two online splits, each with three 3v3 Opens—six total—leading to two Majors. After the Majors, 16 teams with the most RLCS points automatically qualify for a six-day, 20-team World Championship, with four more teams entering through Last Chance Qualifiers based on the four best-performing regions. [43]

The named regions are North America, Europe, South America, MENA, APAC, OCE, and SSA. The announced 3v3 Worlds allocation gave NA/EU four or five teams depending on Kick-Off results, SAM/MENA two each, and APAC/OCE/SSA one each, with a four-region LCQ for remaining places; the exact LCQ regions were still to be determined in that announcement. [44]

The circuit uses RLCS Qualification Points and roster eligibility, including a requirement that at least two of three starting players qualify through citizenship or permanent legal residency. RLCS 1v1 Opens were announced for NA, EU, SAM, and MENA; 2v2 Opens were announced after Major 2. [43], [44]

Kick-Off Weekend was announced for BLAST Studios in Copenhagen, 5–7 December: top Open 1 teams from NA and EU reach the studio stage, the top two from each region enter a four-team final bracket, and its winner directly qualifies for Major 1 while earning its region an additional fifth Worlds slot. Event dates, slots, hosts, and rules can change; consult the current event pages. [44], [45]

2026 Worlds and the next announced event

The RLCS World Championship had completed by the reference date: it ran 15–20 September in Fort Worth, with 20 teams and a USD 1.2 million pool. Team Falcons beat Spacestation 4–0 in the grand final; Falcons received USD 300,000. [69], [70], [71]

The new **RLCS Club Championship** is separate from the completed World Championship and was still upcoming on 14 October. Psyonix announced a 9–13 December 2026 kickoff at London's Copper Box Arena: 20 invited clubs plus four teams from a November open online qualifier, competing for shares of USD 2.5 million. The announcement says clubs then enter regional online leagues toward a 16-team LAN final in 2027. [72]



Figure 25. Original diagram. Worlds result and future event details verified with the event operator and official announcements; the December event was still upcoming at cutoff. [43], [44], [69], [70], [71], [72]

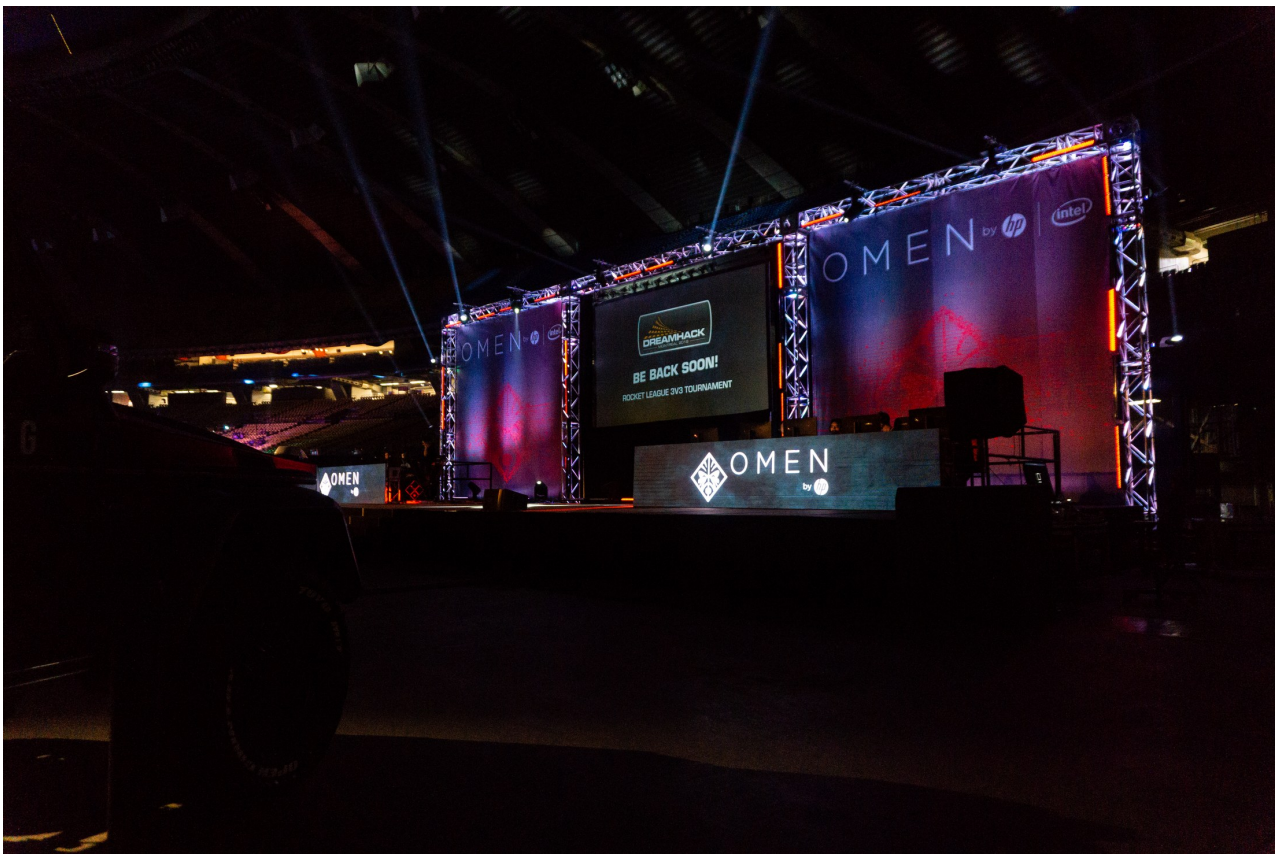


Figure 26. DreamHack Montreal 2018; photo by Ye Fang (Norman) Kuang, CC BY 2.0; resized, uncropped; Commons source page.



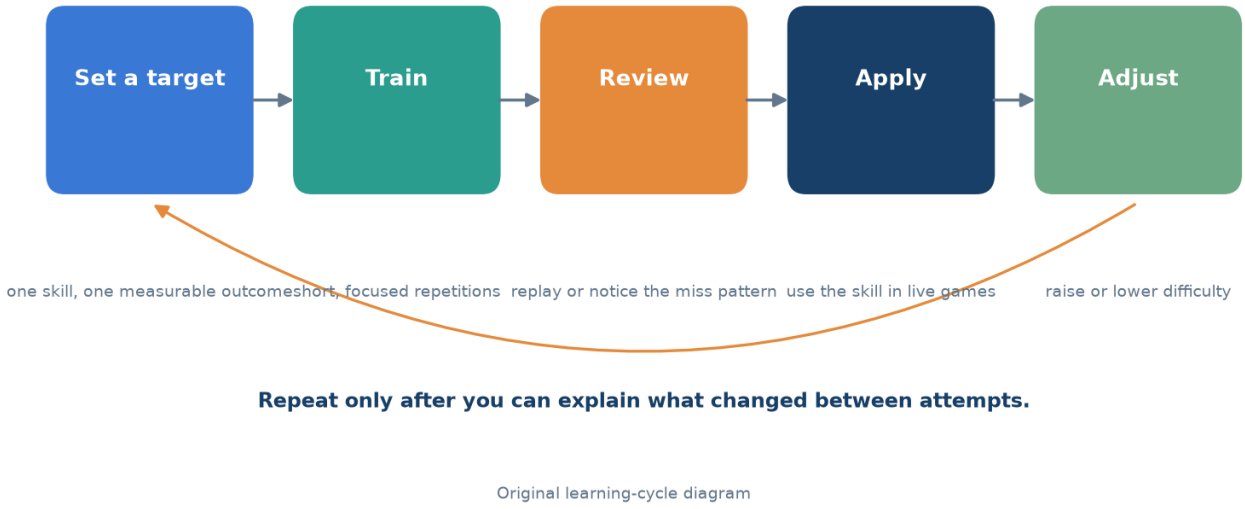
Figure 27. DreamHack Montreal 2018; photo by Ye Fang (Norman) Kuang, CC BY 2.0; resized, uncropped; Commons source page.

8. Training, Replay Review, and Progression

The practice loop

A useful progression is **Tutorials/Training → Free Play → Custom Training → private or casual match → replay review → one focused ranked test**. Psyonix's tutorial and training coverage supports this general path; the precise schedule below is editorial rather than a developer-prescribed program. [46], [47]

A useful practice loop



Original learning-cycle diagram

Figure 28. Original diagram. Practice cycle synthesizing the documented tools; the schedule is editorial. [46], [47], [50]

Training is a loop: learn, repeat, vary, review, transfer



Figure 29. Original diagram. Training-tool capabilities summarized from official tutorial, Free Play, Custom Training, and replay notes. [46], [47], [48], [49], [50]

A practical 20-minute beginner session:

- 5 minutes: controls, throttle, braking, and ground touches.
- 10 minutes: basic shots and saves.
- 5 minutes: a private or casual game with one focus.

Free Play controls include Take Possession, Start Dribble, Pass Ball, Launch Ball, and Defend Shot. An advanced 10–15 minute block can progress from recoveries and wavedashes to first touch, controlled dribble, wall-to-air attempts, and redirects. [47]

Custom Training supports deliberate practice: jump to any shot, select or shuffle shots, mirror shots to the opposite side, save progress, reset a pack, and review progress. Since v2.66, modifiers can alter ball speed, ball location, ball height, vehicle location, vehicle rotation, ground spawning, replay skipping, and round-start input delay. Begin with zero modifiers, then add one at a time so the drill remains interpretable. [48], [49]

Psyonix’s v2.54 notes say players receive weekly Custom Training recommendations based on current rank. Created packs can be uploaded to generate a code that others can browse/search. Verify a pack in-game before recommending it; old codes are not evidence of current availability. [48]

A focused curriculum

Player stage	Main work	Avoid
Beginner	Ground shots, saves, Ball Cam, kickoffs, recoveries	Chasing aerial highlights before landing reliably
Intermediate	Aerial strikes, wall shots, backboard clears, dribbles, shadow defense	Spending all boost on every challenge
Advanced	Fast aerials, redirects, double taps, air dribbles, controlled resets	Using a flashy mechanic when a safe touch wins possession

A practical skill progression—not a fixed rank guarantee

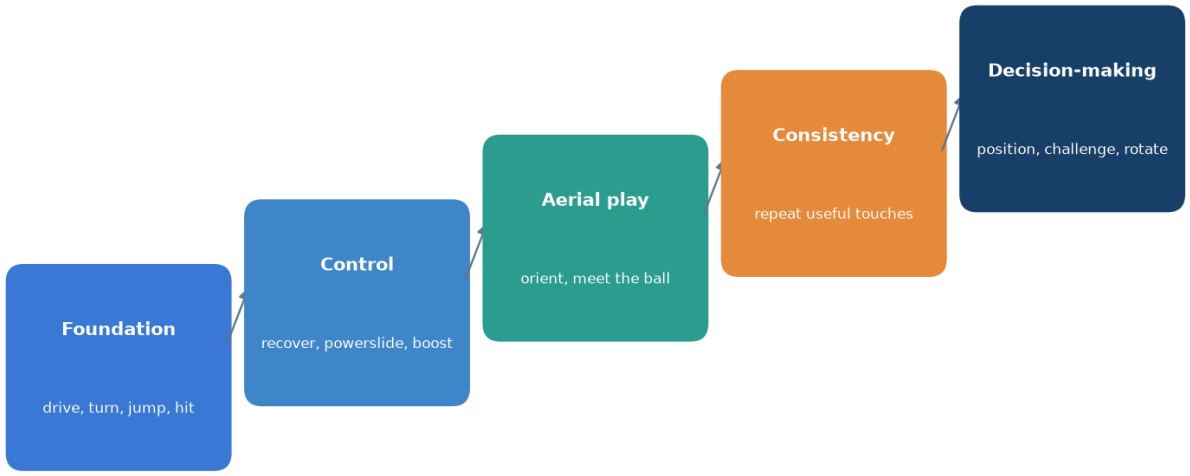


Figure 30. Original diagram. Editorial progression built from official training coverage and community mechanic taxonomy. [13], [35], [46], [47]

Replay review

Match History, introduced with v2.45, shows the 20 most recent matches from the past 30 days and permits saving/naming replays. It identifies playlist, mode, arena, time, score, shots, goals, assists, saves, score, and MVP. [50]

Review one loss from your own and your team’s perspective. Log three repeatable errors—such as poor first touch, premature challenge, or rotation/boost failure—and turn each into a Free Play or Custom Training drill. Save important replays promptly because the official retention window is limited.

Private practice and a weekly routine

Private Match host controls can pause, alter remaining time and score, and restart from kickoff. Use a friend or coach for kickoff repetition, passing patterns, shadowing, backboard defense, or a constrained scrimmage with one objective. [48]

A sustainable four-session week might be:

1. **Fundamentals:** Tutorials/Training plus ground shots.
2. **Mechanics:** Free Play plus one Custom Training pack, including mirrored shots.
3. **Game sense:** A private/casual session and replay review.
4. **Transfer:** Ranked games with one measurable focus.

Workshop/custom maps require a platform caveat. Psyonix documented Steam Workshop maps in 2018, but the supplied current sources do not establish native workshop-map support on consoles or an officially supported Epic workaround. Treat Workshop as a Steam-specific/historical community route unless current official documentation says otherwise. [51]

9. Customization, Progression, and the Item Economy

What changes play—and what does not

The equipped car body is the gameplay-relevant customization choice because it selects a hitbox family. Decals, wheels, boosts/rocket trails, toppers, antennas, engine audio, goal explosions, trails, banners, and titles are presentation or tracking features; no cited source establishes that they improve speed, control, or scoring. Trails display behind the wheels at supersonic speed, and goal explosions replace the default Classic effect. [52], [20]



Figure 31. Distinctive licensed vehicle designs show visual customization; appearance is not a competitive stat upgrade. Historical Rocket League press-kit image; source gallery; rights remain with the relevant rights holder.

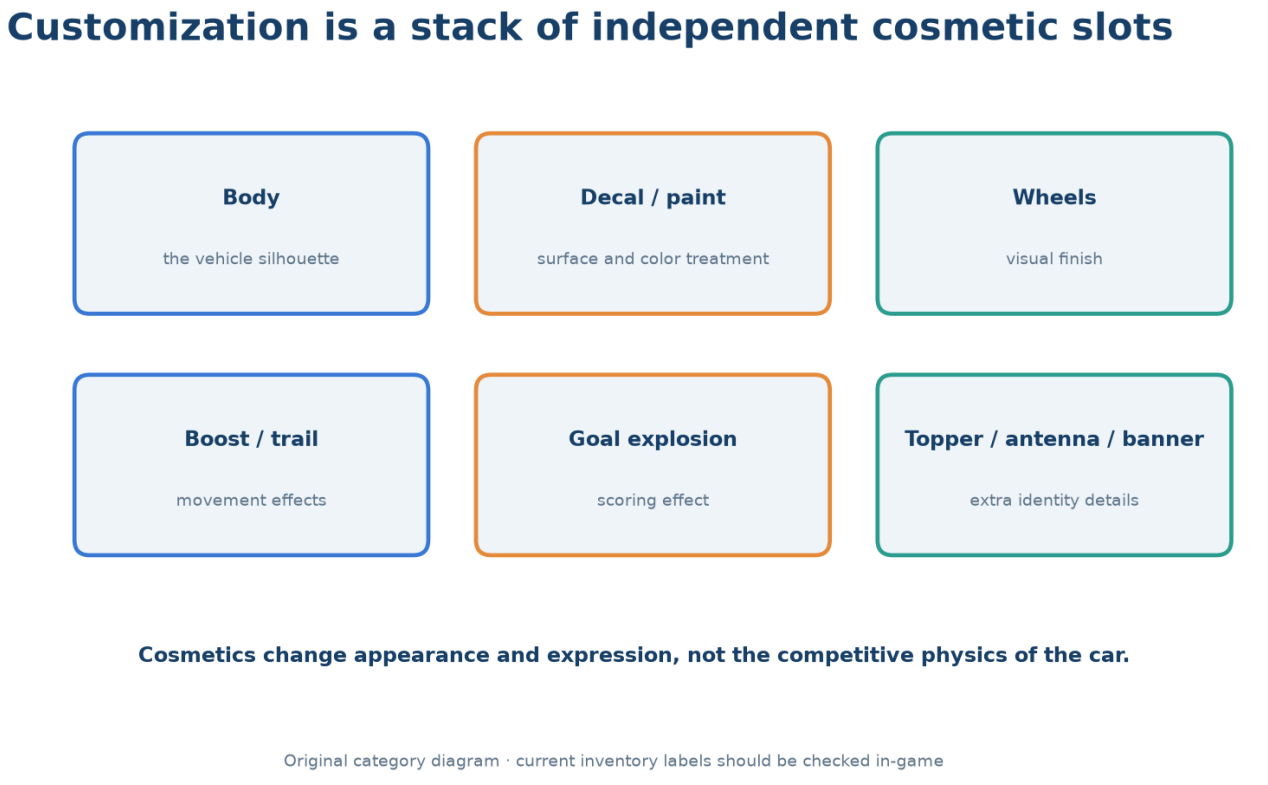


Figure 32. Original diagram. Cosmetic slots and item presentation; only the equipped body selects a standardized hitbox family. [20], [52]

Presets save complete configurations, can be named, equipped separately for Blue and Orange, and randomized. Historical notes increased the limit to 50 car-preset slots. [53]

Painted recolors an item into a named color. **Certified** tracks an online statistic and changes its prefix as milestones are reached; counters advance in online Casual and Competitive games, not Private Matches or offline/Exhibition. These are collection/status features, not gameplay buffs. [54]

The modern economy

Rarity and series describe an item’s position and source pool, not on-field strength. Crates are historical: older documentation described Rare through Black Market items and five-item trade-ups within a series. Blueprints replaced Crates in the 2019 economy update. Revealing a Blueprint shows the item and Credit build cost; spending Credits builds one copy. That update also launched the Item Shop, converted Keys to Credits, added Blueprint/Gift Pack tabs and archiving, and made Credits usable for Shop, Rocket Pass, and Blueprint purchases. [53], [55]

Player-to-player trading was removed in v2.34, released 5 December 2023 at 4 p.m. PST / 6 December 2023 at 00:00 UTC. Existing trades were not reversed. Trade In remains for eligible duplicates/unwanted items; third-party trading sites are not affiliated with Psyonix/Epic. [56], [57]

Season 24’s Rocket Pass arrived 23 September 2026 with the season. Use the live in-game pass for current tier, price, and reward details; historical Premium prices and reward quantities should not be carried forward. [58], [59]

Linked inventories

One Epic Games Account can link platform accounts under a selected Primary Platform. The current support list says shared categories include earned free drops, Season Rewards/Titles, Rocket Pass items, Item Shop purchases (while the bundle's Credits remain on the purchase platform), Blueprints and built items, Legacy Pack DLC, Esports Shop purchases, Fan Rewards, RLCS attendee items, and Premium DLC. Purchased Credit balances, platform-exclusive items, and Ultimate Edition on-disc Batman/DC DLC are exceptions. [60]

The older progression explanation says the Primary Platform supplies Rocket Pass progress, rank, and XP level; Credits and Esports Tokens remain platform-tied. Linking does not merge conflicting data, and unlinking does not allow a platform to be casually moved to another Epic Games Account. [5], [61]

Licensed-body compatibility can also be item-specific. For example, the Lightning McQueen body can use some toppers, boosts, trails, and goal explosions but not antennas. Do not generalize one licensed body's restrictions to all bodies. [62]



Figure 33. Licensed Mario-themed car designs illustrate a special, platform-linked cosmetic collection; see current sharing exceptions. [60] Historical Rocket League press-kit image; source gallery; rights remain with the relevant rights holder.

10. Online Play, Platforms, Performance, and Accessibility

Cross-platform play and communication

Cross-Platform Play can be disabled in Settings > Gameplay, but Epic warns that queues may lengthen; players cannot exclude only one platform. Party text chat works across platforms. In matches, only Quick Chat is visible cross-platform; typed in-game messages are limited to same-platform players. [63]

Voice Chat is fully cross-platform, with Party and Team channels and no opposing-team voice. Controls are under Settings > Chat > Voice Chat Settings; PC offers input/output selectors and Push-to-Talk, while incoming voice volume is under Settings > Audio. Voice reporting keeps the last five minutes on-device and uploads audio only with a submitted report; submitted clips are normally deleted after 14 days or the sanction duration. Adult and under-18 settings have different protections. [64], [65]

Clubs support up to 20 members including owner and manager. Current stats track goals, saves, and assists with Prospect, Signature, and Premier medals; seasonal milestones reset, and stats require at least two club members in a party. [66]

Online play: identity, party, queue, match

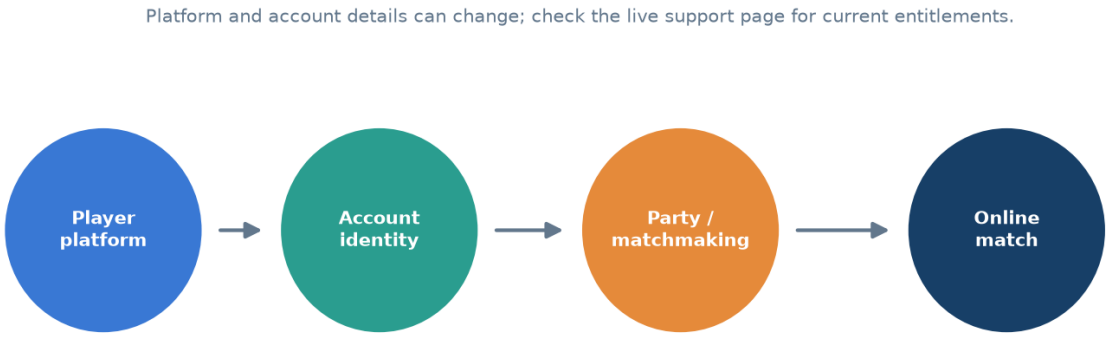


Figure 34. Original diagram. Cross-platform matchmaking differs from account-linked progression and inventory sharing. [5], [63]

Competitive Tournament schedules are region-based and published in UTC for regions including NA, EU, SAM, OCE, and ME. Check the live schedule because times and modes change seasonally. [67]

Published requirements

Epic’s published Windows requirements are:

	Minimum	Recommended
Operating system	64-bit Windows 7 or newer	64-bit Windows 7 or newer
CPU	2.5 GHz dual-core	3.0+ GHz quad-core
RAM	4 GB	8 GB
GPU	GTX 760 / R9 270X or better	GTX 1060 / RX 470 or better
API	DirectX 11	DirectX 11
Network/storage	Broadband; 20 GB	Broadband; 20 GB

These are publisher-published requirements, not performance guarantees. The Epic page retains legacy Mac/Linux tables, but its current prose says Steam Deck/Linux can be played and macOS cannot; the old tables should therefore be treated as historical native-build information. [10]

Stable frame rate and low latency are sensible priorities, but fullscreen, frame cap, VSync, effects, camera, controls, audio, and accessibility preferences should be tested per hardware and player. This is community-tested advice, not an official universal competitive profile. v2.70 added speed-stat graphs, offline hitbox visualization, and expanded Custom Training. [49], [68]

Graphics: clarity versus frame stability

Rocket League’s graphics options affect presentation and visual clarity, not a car’s competitive hitbox. The official v2.76 notes identify SMAA anti-aliasing and the High-quality rendering setting; the patch fixed jagged-edge smoothing and a large-boost flicker issue respectively. For other display choices, use a repeatable test on your own platform rather than copying a “pro preset.” [19], [68]

Setting area	What it changes	Practical use
Resolution and display mode	Image clarity and how the game is presented on the screen.	Prefer a readable native resolution when performance permits; change one option at a time.
Frame cap / VSync	Frame pacing and the feel of input response, depending on hardware/display.	Compare stable frame pacing versus lower latency on your own setup; there is no universal official profile.
Anti-aliasing (SMAA)	Edge smoothing; v2.76 fixed a bug where SMAA did not smooth jagged edges as intended.	Enable/test if edge clarity matters; compare performance and clarity rather than assuming a specific FPS gain.
Quality/effects	Visual detail and effects, including presentation of large boost pickups.	Lower visual load only if your system struggles; prioritize a stable frame rate over decorative effects.
Camera and reticle	Field of view, tracking, free-look, and aiming reference.	Choose a readable view; the new optional center dot supports Free Look, but settings remain personal.

The resolution, frame-cap, VSync, and quality suggestions above are practical/community-tested guidance, not official competitive requirements. The current PC system-requirements page remains the source for the published minimum and recommended hardware table above. [10], [68]



Figure 35. Historical gameplay HUD: score, boost meter, arena boundary, and on-field positioning are visible. Historical Rocket League press-kit image; source gallery; rights remain with the relevant rights holder.



Figure 36. Original diagram. Practical device-by-device checklist, not a universal official competitive graphics profile. [18], [19], [68]

A practical online checklist

Before queueing:

- Confirm the correct Primary Platform and linked Epic account.
- Test controller or keyboard input and deadzone.
- Choose a readable camera and disable Camera Shake if it distracts you.
- Check voice/text settings and use Quick Chat responsibly.
- Prefer stable frame rate and low latency over decorative effects.
- Remember that playlist, tournament, and LTE availability is seasonal.

Rocket League rewards reliable decisions more than a large inventory or a single spectacular mechanic. The enduring path is simple: see the play, manage space and boost, make a useful touch, recover, and communicate.

Glossary

Air dribble: Carrying or repeatedly touching the ball while both car and ball are airborne.

Air Roll: Orientation control while airborne; it does not provide lift.

Backboard: The wall behind a goal; a major rebound and defensive surface.

Ball Cam: Camera mode that aims the view around the ball.

Blueprint: An item reveal showing the item and Credit cost to build it.

Certified: An item attribute that tracks a named online statistic.

Cheat (kickoff): A teammate follows a kickoff challenge at a controlled distance to contest the result.

Competitive: Ranked matchmaking and seasonal rank progression.

Dodge/flip: The second-jump impulse that changes car velocity and orientation.

Fennec: A car body assigned to the Octane hitbox family.

Flip reset: A community technique that restores a dodge when all four wheels contact the ball.

Free Play: Open-ended practice with controls for possession, dribble, pass, launch, and defend-shot scenarios.

Half-flip: A backward flip canceled to turn the car around quickly.

Hitbox: The gameplay collision family assigned to a car body.

LTM/LTE: Limited-time mode/event; availability is temporary.

MMR: Internal matchmaking rating used to estimate skill; official universal thresholds are not published in the supplied sources.

Musty flick: A backflip flick with the car nose pointed down; community terminology.

Overtime: Competitive continuation after a tied regulation score, resolved by the first goal under the cited rules.

Primary Platform: The linked platform whose progression supplies rank, XP, and Rocket Pass state.

Quick Chat: Preset messages visible across platforms.

Rocket Pass: Seasonal progression and cosmetic acquisition track.

Speedflip: A diagonal flip with rapid cancel and corrective steering/air roll; community terminology.

Supersonic: The high-speed state; RLBot reports a community technical threshold of 2200 uu/s.

Third man: The deepest player in a rotation, positioned to cover a challenge or counterattack.

Trade In: In-game exchange of eligible unwanted/duplicate items; distinct from removed player-to-player trading.

Wavedash: A flip timed as wheels contact a surface to preserve or gain speed.

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Research gaps and cautions

- No complete static source supplied a dated 14 October 2026 snapshot of every active Casual, Competitive, Arcade, LTE, or Tournament slot; the live Play menu, News, and Challenges panels are authoritative.
- No cited official page publishes universal numeric MMR cutoffs for every rank/division.
- RLBot geometry, physics, jump, and boost values are community-maintained technical references; they can vary by map, version, or measurement method.
- Small-boost-pad refresh timing conflicts between supplied sources (4 seconds in RLBot; 5 seconds in Dignitas); this handbook does not present either as an immutable official rule.
- Official sources do not provide one universal camera preset, graphics profile, or platform-independent accessibility/settings matrix.
- Workshop/custom-map compatibility across Steam, Epic, PlayStation, Xbox, and Nintendo is not established by the supplied current sources.
- Exact Season 24 Rocket Pass price, tier schedule, and complete reward list were not verified; only headline items named in the official announcement are included.
- RLCS announcements left some details—such as certain LCQ regions and later event amendments—subject to official updates. The December Club Championship was announced but had not yet occurred at the reference date.
- The cited competitive rules are esports rules and should not be generalized to every casual, private, offline, or limited-time mode. The reported 2027 Unreal Engine 6 roadmap is not a playable build or a published hardware requirement.